(a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 (d) 3 only

Ans. (b): Common Myna are the birds stalking alongside the cattle to seize the insects disturbed by their movement through grasses. The common Myna is readily indentified by the brown body, black hooded head and the bare yellow patch behind the eye.

85. Consider the following pairs :

Wetlands		Confluence of rivers
1. Harike Wetlands	:	Confluence of Beas and Satluj/ Sutlej
2. Keoladeo Ghana National Park	:	Confluence of Banas and Chambal
3. Kolleru Lake/	:	Confluence of Musi and Krishna

Which of the above pairs is /are correctly matched?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (a): Keoladeo Ghana National Park is located at the confluence of the Banganga and Gambhira rivers in the Bharatpur district of Rajasthan. Kolleru Lake is located in the Godavari and Krishna River deltas in Andhra Pradesh.

86. The most important strategy for the conservation of biodiversity together with traditional human life is the establishment of
(a) Biosphere reserves (b) Botanical gardens
(c) National parks (d) Wildlife sanctuaries

Ans. (a): Botanical gardens and National Parks are the wrong options as in botanical gardens people don't live and in national parks, human activity is totally prohibited.
In wildlife sanctuaries, human activity is partially allowed. Therefore the biosphere reserves are the best option.
Biosphere Reserve is an area of active cooperation between the management and the local people, where activities like settlements, cropping, forestry, recreation and other economic activities are carried in harmony with the conservation goals.

87. Consider the following statements regarding 'Earth Hour' :
1. It is an initiative of UNEP and UNESCO.
2. It is a movement in which the participants switch off the lights for one hour on a certain day every year.
3. It is a movement to raise to awareness about the climate change and the need to save the planet.

Which of the statements given above is /are correct?
(a) 1 and 3 (b) 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (c): Earth Hour is a worldwide movement for the planet organized by the World Wide Fund for Nature WWF. The event is held worldwide annually, encouraging individuals communities, households and businesses to turn off 8:30 to 9:30 P.M. to raise awareness about climate change and the need to save the planet.

88. With reference to 'Eco–Sensitive Zones', Which of the following statements is /are correct ?
1. Eco-Sensitive Zones are the areas that are declared under the Wildlife (Protection) Act 1972.
2. The purpose of the declaration of Eco–Sensitive Zones is to prohibit all kinds of human activities in these zones except agriculture.

Select the correct answer using the code given below :
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (d): The Eco-sensitive zone is declared under (Section 3) Environment (Protection) Act, 1986. Eco-sensitive zones are areas in India around Protected Areas, National Park and sanctuaries, which are considered fragile eco zones. There are some activities allowed in these areas are cottage industries, erection of telecom and electricity wires, tourism, hot-air balloons, tourism etc.

89. Consider the following statements :
1. Animal welfare Board of India is established under the Environment (Protection)Act, 1986 .
2. National Tiger Conservation Authority is a statutory body.
3. National Ganga River Basin Authority is Chaired by the Prime Minister.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (b): The Animal Welfare Board of India was established in 1962 under section 4 of the prevention of cruelty to Animals Act 1960. The National Tiger Conservation Authority is set up under the chairmanship of the Minister for Environment and Forests and is a statutory body. National Ganga River Basin Authority was established by the Central Government of India on 20th February 2009. The Prime Minister is the chairperson of the authority.

CURRENT AFFAIRS

90. Consider the following languages.
1. Gujarati 2. Kannada
3. Telugu

Which of the above has/have been declared as 'Classical Language/ Languages' by the Government ?
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (c) : Tamil language has been conferred classical language status by the Government of India in 2004, Sanskrit language in 2005, Telugu, Kannada and Malayalam language in 2008. In February 2014, the Government of India also gave the status to Odia language. Now, all 6 languages have got the status of classical language.

91. With reference to a grouping of countries known as BRICS, consider the following statements :
1. The first Summit of BRICS was held in Rio de Janeiro in 2009.
2. South Africa was the last to join the BRICS grouping.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (b): BRICS is the acronym for an association of the five major emerging national economies : Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa. The grouping was originally known as "BRIC" before the inclusion of South Africa in 2010. The BRIC first formal summit held in Yekaterinburg (Russia) commenced on 16th June 2009.

92.Recently a series of uprisings of people referred to as 'Arab Spring' originally started from?
(a) Egypt (b) Lebanon
(c) Syria (d) Tunisia

Ans. (d): Arab Spring was a series of anti-government protests, uprisings, and armed rebellions that spread across much of the Arab world in the early 2010s. Arab Spring began with the overthrow of ruler of Tunisia, Ben Ali who fled to Saudi Arabia.

93. Consider the following pairs :

Region often in news		Country
1. Chechnya	:	Russian
2. Darfur	:	Federation Mali
3. Swat Valley	:	Iraq

Which of the above pairs is/are correctly matched?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (a): Chechnya is a republic of Russia, which was formed on 10th January, 1993. It is 100 km from the Caspian Sea in the southern part of Eastern Europe in the North Caucasus. Darfur is located in western Sudan, while Swat valley is located in the Khyber Pakhutunkhwa province of Pakistan.

ART & CULTURE

94. Consider the following towns of India
1. Bhadrachalam 2. Chanderi
3. Kancheepuram 4. Karnal

Which of the above are famous for the production of traditional sarees/ fabric ?
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1,2 and 3 (d) 1, 3 and 4

Ans. (b): Kancheepuram, located in Tamil Nadu, is famous worldwide for the production of traditional silk sarees. Chanderi is the township in the Ashok Nagar district of Madhya Pradesh, which is also famous for manufacturing special types of silk sarees.

95. With reference to the Famous Sattriya dance consider the following statements.
1. Sattriya is a combination of music, dance, and drama
2. It is a centuries-old living tradition of Vaishnavites of Assam.
3. It is based on classical Ragas and Talas of devotional songs composed by Tulsidas, Kabir and Mirabai.

Which of the statements given above is /are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (b): Sattriya form uses a variety of hand gestures and foot positions. It also has its own style of music based on classical ragas and the talas (rhythm) of Borgeet (development songs composed by Sankardeva and Madhaveva).

96. With reference to India's culture and tradition. What is 'Kalaripayattu'?
(a) It is an ancient Bhakri cult of Shaivism still prevealent in some parts of South India.
(b) It is an ancient style bronze and brass work still found in southern part of Coromandel area.
(c) It is an ancient form of dance-drama and a living tradition in the northern part of Malabar.
(d) It is an ancient martial art and an living . tradition in some parts of South India.

Ans. (d): Kalaripayattu is an ancient martial art and a living tradition in Kerala and Tamil Nadu.

97. Consider the following pairs

1. Garba	:	Gujarat
2. Mohiniattam	:	Odisha
3. Yakshagana	:	Karnataka

Which of the pairs given above is /are correctly matched?
(a) only 1 (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1,2 and 3

Ans. (c) : Garba is a major folk dance of Gujarat. Mohiniattam is a classical dance of Kerala. The Yakshagana practised in Karnataka is an amalgam of music, dance and dialogue.

98. A community of people called Manganiyars is well known for their .
(a) Martial arts in North – East India
(b) Musical tradition in North- West India
(c) Classical vocal music in South India
(d) Pietra dura tradition in Central India

Ans. (b) : Manganiyars is a tribal community(Muslim) found in the desert of Rajasthan (mostly in Barmer and Jaisalmer. This community is known for following a particular type of music tradition.

MISCELLANEOUS

99. With reference to Agni-IV Missile, which of the following statements is/are correct ?
1. It is a surface-to-surface missile.
2. It is fuelled by liquid propellant only.
3. It can deliver one tonne nuclear warheads about 7500km away.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:
(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (a): Not only Agni-IV but all the missiles in this series are surface to-surface missile. It uses solid propellant as fuel. It can deliver one tonne nuclear warheads upto a maximum distance of 4000 km.

100. Chaitra 1 of the National calendar based on the Saka Era corresponds to which one of the following dates of the Gregorian calendar in a normal year of 365 days.
(a) 22nd March (or 21st March)
(b) 15th May (or 16th May)
(c) 31st March (or 30th March)
(d) 21st April (or 20th April)

Ans. (a): Chaitra 1 of the National calendar based on the Saka Era corresponds to 22nd March of the Gregorian calendar in a normal year of 355 days and on 21st March in a leap year.
The Saka era marked the beginning of the Saka Samvat; a historic Hindu calendar which was later introduced as 'Indian National Calendar' in 1957.